

3.1.3 Catholic Christianity

Students should be aware that Catholic Christianity is one of the diverse religious traditions and beliefs in Great Britain today and that the main religious tradition in Great Britain is Christianity. This knowledge may be applied throughout the assessment of the specified content.

Students should study the beliefs, teachings and practices of Catholic Christianity specified below and their basis in Catholic Christian sources of wisdom and authority. They should be able to refer to scripture and/or sacred texts where appropriate. Some texts are prescribed for study in the content set out below and questions may be set on them. Students may refer to any relevant text in their answers and AQA will publish a list of appropriate texts as part of the supporting material for

this specification. These additional texts will not be required for study, alternatives may be used, and questions will not be set on them.

Students should study the influence of the beliefs, teachings and practices studied on individuals, communities and societies.

Common and divergent views within Christianity in the way beliefs and teachings are understood and expressed should be included throughout. Students may refer to a range of Christian perspectives in their answers including Orthodox and Protestant. They must study the specific differences identified below.

3.1.3.1 Beliefs and teachings

Key beliefs

- One God as a Trinity of persons: Father, Son and Holy Spirit, as expressed in the Nicene Creed; the scriptural origins of this belief and its development in the Council of Nicaea.
- Creation: Biblical accounts of creation (Genesis 1 and 2) and their significance for an understanding of the nature of God, the dignity of human beings and of humanity's relationship with creation. Different Christian beliefs about creation.
- Incarnation: the belief in Jesus as incarnate Son, divine Word, both fully God and fully human and the scriptural origins of this belief.
- Redemption: the significance of the life, death, resurrection and ascension of Jesus for Catholic beliefs about salvation and grace.
- Beliefs about life after death: resurrection, judgement, heaven, hell and purgatory.

The seven sacraments

- The meaning and significance of 'sacrament' and the importance of the sacramental nature of reality.
- The names, meanings and effects of the seven sacraments:
 - baptism
 - confirmation
 - reconciliation
 - anointing of the sick
 - matrimony
 - holy orders
 - the eucharist: its status as 'the source and summit of Christian life'; different Christian views about its meaning and importance.

3.1.3.2 Practices

Worship

- Prayer:
 - prayer as 'the raising of the mind and heart to God'
 - formal prayers and informal prayer, including different views about their relative importance
 - the meaning and importance of the Lord's Prayer.
- The role and importance of forms of popular piety including the Rosary and the Stations of the Cross.
- The role and importance of pilgrimage, including a study of one place of Roman Catholic pilgrimage, and different Christian views about the importance of pilgrimage.
- The funeral rite and its significance.

The work of the Church

- Catholic beliefs about the essential duty to 'love our neighbour' in concrete ways locally, nationally and globally and how these beliefs are reflected in:
 - Catholic social teaching including Gaudium et Spes paragraph 26
 - Catholic teaching on justice, peace and reconciliation
 - The work of Catholic agencies including CAFOD, Trocaire, Missio.
- The meaning and significance of mission and evangelism for Catholics today, globally and in Great Britain, both nationally and locally.
- The aims and importance of the Society of Saint Vincent de Paul (SVP).
- The aims and importance of either the Corrymeela community or Pax Christi.